



Basic Emergency Care

Introduction & Action Plan in Danger

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What is Basic Emergency Care (BEC)?

- Basic Emergency Care refers to the immediate care provided to a sick or injured person during the first critical minutes before advanced medical treatment is available.
- It focuses on simple but life-saving actions that prevent death and deterioration.
- BEC forms the foundation of all emergency and trauma care systems worldwide.



Airway & Breathing



Life-threatening Bleeding



Trauma & Shock



Sudden Illness

Why Basic Emergency Care is Important

- Most preventable deaths occur before reaching a hospital.
- Airway obstruction, hypoxia, and severe bleeding can cause death within minutes.
- Early basic interventions significantly improve survival and outcomes.



Who Provides Basic Emergency Care?

- Medical students, healthcare workers, and trained first responders.
- Any trained individual acting within their level of competence.
- Early responders play a critical role before ambulance arrival.



Layperson

First
responder

Doctor

Nurse

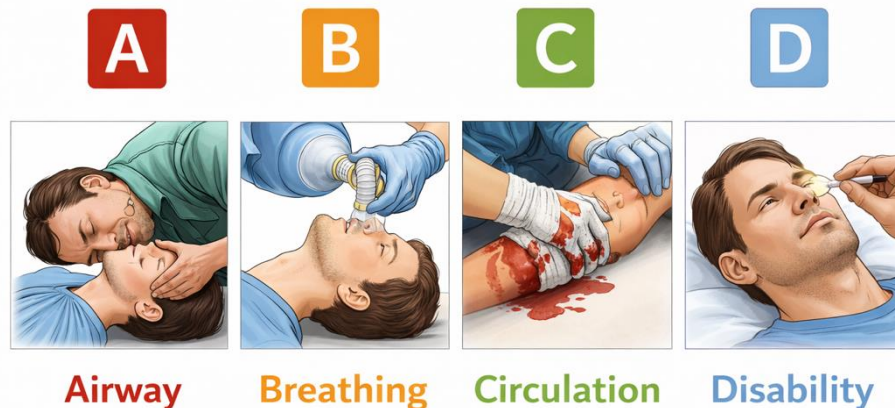
Family
member

Bystander

Understanding an Emergency

- An emergency is a sudden, unexpected event that threatens life, limb, or function.
- Emergencies are time-critical and unpredictable.
- Rapid assessment and structured response are essential.

ABCD: Key Priorities in Emergency Care



Primary Survey – ABCDE (WHO Approach)

- The ABCDE approach is a structured method recommended by the World Health Organization (WHO) for the initial assessment and management of acutely ill or injured patients.
 - A – Airway (with cervical spine protection): Ensure the airway is open and protected.
 - B – Breathing: Assess breathing and provide oxygen or ventilation if needed.
 - C – Circulation: Control life-threatening bleeding and assess circulation.
 - D – Disability: Perform a rapid neurological assessment.
 - E – Exposure & Environment: Fully expose the patient to identify injuries while preventing hypothermia.
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- Life-threatening problems are treated immediately when identified, and the ABCDE assessment is repeated continuously until definitive care is available.



Action Plan in Danger

- A structured approach used to manage emergency situations safely and effectively.
- Helps prevent panic and unsafe actions.
- Ensures rescuer safety and prioritizes life-saving care.



Assess the Scene



Plan & Act Safely



Prioritize Care

Scene Safety – First Priority

- Always assess the scene before approaching the casualty.
- Look for dangers such as traffic, fire, electricity, or violence.
- A rescuer must never become another victim.



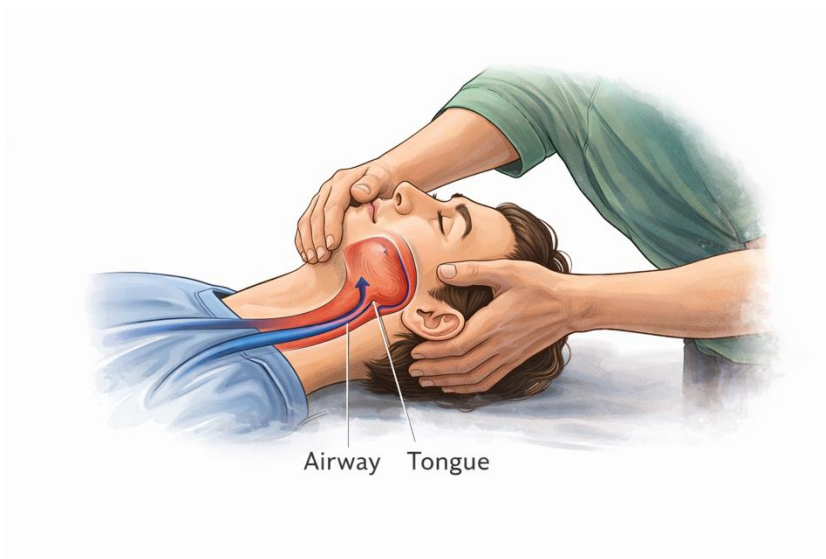
Initial Casualty Assessment

- Approach calmly and identify yourself.
- Check responsiveness using voice and gentle physical stimulus.
- Unresponsive patients require immediate action.



Airway Assessment

- An unconscious patient may have airway obstruction due to tongue relaxation.
- Open the airway using head-tilt chin-lift if no trauma is suspected.
- Maintaining airway patency is a life-saving priority.



Breathing Assessment

- Look for chest rise and fall.
- Listen for breath sounds.
- Feel for airflow from the mouth or nose.



Life-Threatening Bleeding

- Severe external bleeding can lead to rapid death.
- Apply firm direct pressure immediately.
- Use available clean materials if bandages are unavailable.



Calling for Help

- Activate emergency medical services as early as possible.
- Provide clear information about location and patient condition.
- Delegate tasks to bystanders when available.



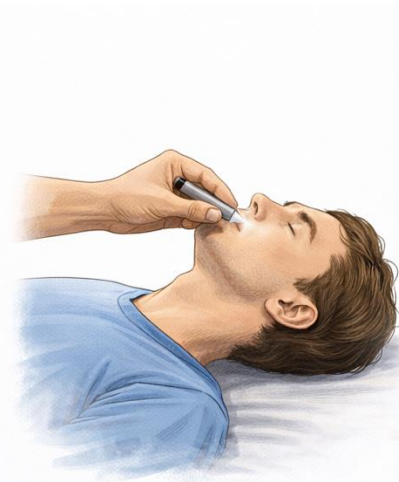
Patient Positioning

- Unconscious but breathing patients should be placed in the recovery position.
- Helps maintain airway patency and prevent aspiration.
- Avoid unnecessary movement in trauma patients.

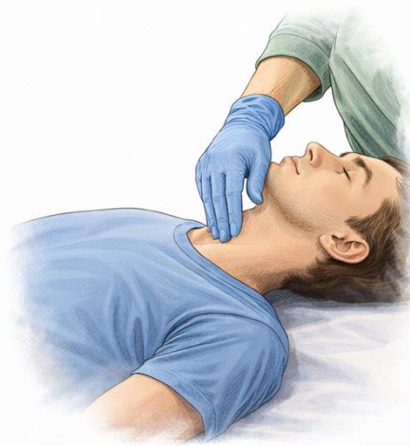


Continuous Reassessment

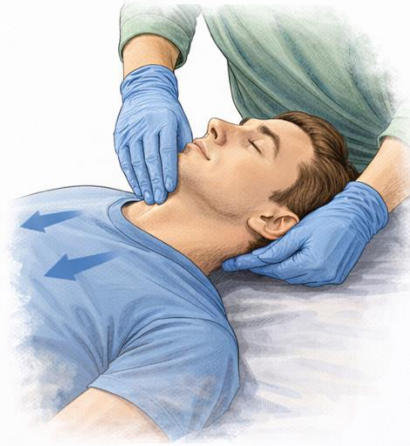
- Patient condition can change rapidly.
- Regularly reassess airway, breathing, and consciousness.
- Stay with the patient until help arrives.



Check Pupils



Monitor Pulse



Watch Breathing

Common Mistakes in Emergencies

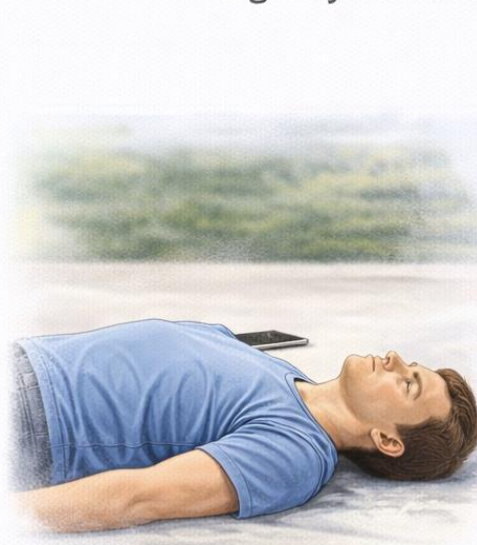
- Ignoring scene safety.
- Delaying activation of emergency services.
- Attempting procedures beyond training level.



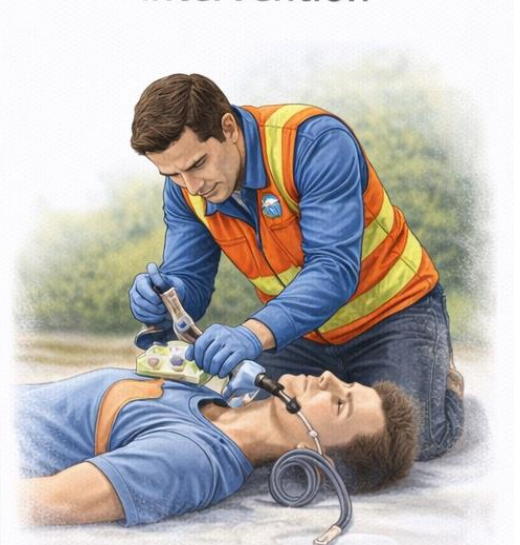
Ignoring scene safety



Delayed activation
of emergency services

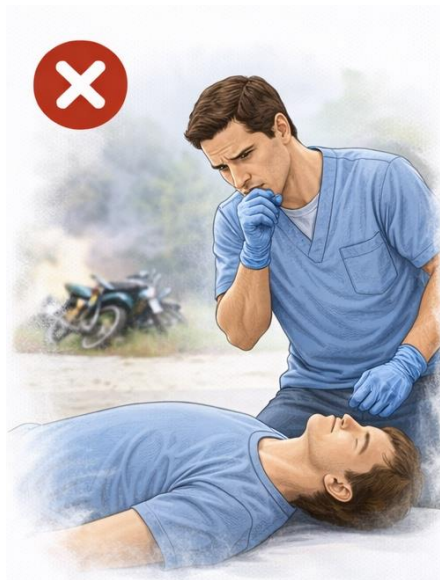


Unsafe
Intervention



Role of the Medical Student

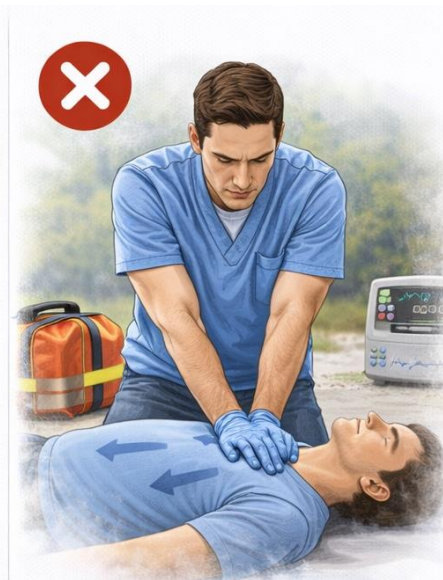
- Act within your level of training.
- Support senior responders.
- Maintain professionalism and calm behavior.



Hesitation



Panic



Tunnel Vision

Key Take-Home Concepts

- Safety comes first.
- Structured assessment saves lives.
- Simple actions make a major difference.



Resources & Further Reading

- World Health Organization (WHO). Basic Emergency Care: Approach to the Acutely Ill and Injured.
- American College of Surgeons. Advanced Trauma Life Support (ATLS) – Student Course Manual.
- Tintinalli JE. Tintinalli's Emergency Medicine: A Comprehensive Study Guide.
- Oxford Handbook of Emergency Medicine.
- WHO. Emergency Care Systems Framework.